Country Intelligence: Company Research & HubSpot

Custom research that turns a Project Director's request into a sourced, commercially qualified list of companies and their leaders, plus a reviewed path from that list into HubSpot. Every record is checked for duplicates, approved by the Director and assigned to a team member before it is created.

Based on the TRC Country Intelligence & Pipeline Engine functional brief and pipeline flowchart (Draft 1.0). Covers custom company and leader research and the complete HubSpot integration.

USER STORIES	ROLES	ESTIMATED EFFORT
48 · US-169 – US-216	**Team member, Project Director, Admin**	**65 hours**

Roles

ROLE	ACCESS
Team member	Sees assigned projects; reads research lists and company and leader profiles; saves and rates results; sees HubSpot status.
Project Director	Everything a team member can do, plus runs research, adds companies manually, marks Not relevant, resolves duplicates, adds companies and contacts to HubSpot and assigns them to team members. Set per project.
Admin	Everything, on every project, plus creates and closes projects, assigns teams, connects HubSpot, edits research prompts and reviews usage and cost.

User stories — summary

ID	AREA	STORY
PROJECTS & ACCESS		
US-169	PROJECT	Create a country project
US-170	PROJECT	Project status
US-171	TEAM	Assign the Project Director and team
US-172	ACCESS	See only my projects
US-173	PRIVACY	Privacy and data notice
CUSTOM COMPANY RESEARCH		

US-174	REQUEST	Research request in five modes
US-175	SCOPE	Sectors and languages chosen automatically
US-176	LIMITS	Cost check before a run
US-177	PROGRESS	Research runs in the background
US-178	RESULTS	Company results list
US-179	QUALIFICATION	Commercial qualification
US-180	EXCLUSIONS	Non-prospects excluded
US-181	COMPANY	Company narrative
US-182	LEADER	CEO and leader trajectory
US-183	SOURCES	Sources and evidence on every claim
US-184	PRIORITY	Why each company was included
US-185	BILATERAL	Publication-country connection
US-186	GOVERNMENT	Government links and institutional contacts
US-187	FILTER	Filter and sort results
US-188	REFINE	Refine a list with a follow-up
US-189	PROFILE	Research one company in depth
US-190	MANUAL	Add a company manually
US-191	SUPPRESS	Mark Not relevant
US-192	FEEDBACK	Save and rate results
US-193	ARCHIVE	Research archive and search
HUBSPOT INTEGRATION		
US-194	SETUP	Connect HubSpot and map owners
US-195	CHECK	Cross-check every result
US-196	MATCHING	Smart company and contact matching
US-197	EXISTING	Existing prospects stay visible
US-198	DUPLICATES	Resolve a possible duplicate
US-199	ADD	Review and add a company and its leader
US-200	BULK	Bulk add selected companies

US-201	ASSIGN	Mandatory assignment
US-202	CONTACT	Add a missing CEO to an existing company
US-203	ASSOCIATION	Fix a contact's company link
US-204	GOVERNMENT	Add a government contact
US-205	TAG	Tag records with the project
US-206	DATA	Only verified data, editable before approval
US-207	LOG	CRM action log
US-208	ACTIVITY	HubSpot activity read back
TRACKING & GUARDRAILS		
US-209	OVERVIEW	Project activity and quality overview
US-210	ANALYTICS	Usage and cost in analytics
US-211	PROMPTS	Versioned research prompts
US-212	FAILURE	Research run fails partway
US-213	HUBSPOT	HubSpot unavailable
US-214	SECURITY	Roles and project status enforced
US-215	RACE	Re-check at approval
US-216	SMALL MARKET	Fewer qualified companies than requested

User stories & acceptance criteria

PROJECTS & ACCESS

US-169 PROJECT

Create a country project

As **an Admin**, *I want to create a country project with its country, publication and team, so that all research runs in the right country and publication context.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Required: country, media/publication, publication country, Project Director, team members, start date
- Publication country defaults from the publication and can be changed
- Creating a project starts no research and spends no AI cost
- Two projects can cover the same country for different publications; each keeps its own research and decisions

US-170 PROJECT

Project status

As **an Admin**, *I want to set a project to Active, Paused or Closed, so that research only runs where TRC is actively working.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Active: research and HubSpot actions are available
- Paused: no new research or HubSpot additions; existing results stay readable
- Closed: read-only; an Admin can reopen it
- Every status change records who made it and when

US-171 TEAM

Assign the Project Director and team

As **an Admin**, *I want to assign one Project Director and the team members, so that the right people see the project and can own HubSpot records.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Exactly one Director per project; changing the Director keeps all past research
- Membership changes apply on the user's next request
- Assigning a user grants them access to the module

US-172 ACCESS

See only my projects

As **a team member or Director**, *I want to see only the projects I am assigned to, so that I always work in the right country context.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Project list shows country, publication, Director, status and last research date
- Opening another project by direct link redirects to my project list
- No research is possible outside an assigned project
- Admins see every project

US-173 PRIVACY

Privacy and data notice

As **a user**, *I want to see once how my activity in the module is used, so that I know what TRC retains.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Shown on first entry with the wording from the brief and dismissed with Got it
- Dismissal is stored per user, not per browser
- Always available afterwards through a Privacy and data use link

CUSTOM COMPANY RESEARCH

US-174 REQUEST

Research request in five modes

As **a Project Director**, *I want to ask for company research in plain language, so that I can build pipeline when the existing one is not enough.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Modes: broad multi-sector, single sector, single company, CEO/leader, government portfolio
- Example prompts in the form, e.g. “Find the 80 leading established companies in Ghana” or “Identify the leading companies connected to Nigeria’s infrastructure minister”
- Optional target count, up to about 80 companies per request
- Country and publication country are taken from the project
- Off-topic or placeholder requests are rejected before any AI cost
- A company name that matches several companies asks the Director to pick the right one first

US-175 SCOPE

Sectors and languages chosen automatically

As **a Project Director**, *I want to have the system choose the sectors and source languages, so that I don’t have to configure them by hand.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Sectors come from TRC’s research universe, weighted to the country’s economy (e.g. mining weighted up where it is the main export)
- The chosen sectors and the reason are shown at the top of the results
- Naming sectors in the request overrides the automatic choice
- Searches English and the country’s main business language(s); each source shows its language
- Output is in English; non-English quotes show the original with a translation

US-176 LIMITS

Cost check before a run

As **a Project Director**, *I want to see the expected cost before research runs, so that large lists are a deliberate choice.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Estimated cost shown before starting
- Blocked before any AI call if it would exceed my token limit
- Single company and leader searches use a smaller reserve than full lists

US-177 PROGRESS

Research runs in the background

As **a Project Director**, *I want to let a long research run continue if I leave the page, so that I am not stuck waiting.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Shows the stage (finding, qualifying, profiling, HubSpot check) and how many companies are done
- Leaving and returning shows current progress; finished results load without re-running
- Results are saved as they complete, so nothing finished is lost

US-178 RESULTS

Company results list

As **a project user**, *I want to see the key facts for every company in a list, so that I can judge each one quickly.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Company, website, sector, headquarters, CEO or main decision-maker and position, ownership (public, private, state-owned, group)
- Revenue and year, scale indicators, international operations, sector ranking, recent developments
- Government connection, publication-country connection, qualification, reason for inclusion, HubSpot status, sources
- Ordered by priority, not alphabetically

US-179 QUALIFICATION

Commercial qualification

As **a project user**, *I want to see every company labelled by commercial size, so that we focus on companies that can sign advertising contracts.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Labels: Qualified, Likely qualified, Scale uncertain, Not commercially qualified
- USD 60 million annual revenue is the threshold; revenue shows original currency, year, USD conversion and source
- Without revenue: “Revenue unverified” plus the scale indicators used (employees, market share, ranking, listing, assets, branches, capacity, major contracts, group)
- Revenue and company size are never estimated or invented
- Not commercially qualified companies are hidden by default and available through a filter

US-180 EXCLUSIONS

Non-prospects excluded

As **a Project Director**, *I want to keep non-prospects out of the list, so that the list is commercially usable.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Academics, NGOs, start-ups, small businesses, early-stage and speculative companies, and individuals without an established company are not returned as prospects
- A collapsed note shows how many candidates were excluded and why

US-181 COMPANY

Company narrative

As **a project user**, *I want to read the company's story, not only its data, so that I can explain why it matters to the country and the report.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- History, main activities, market position, national importance, international presence
- Growth, major investments, expansion plans, export markets, partnerships, recent performance
- Government relationships, link to national development goals and to the publication country, milestones, recent news
- Only sections with sourced content are shown; nothing is padded

US-182 LEADER

CEO and leader trajectory

As **a project user**, *I want to have the leader researched as carefully as the company, so that I can personalise the approach and prepare a better interview.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Current role, career history, education, international experience, major achievements
- Transformation and investments led, leadership philosophy, past interviews, speeches and quotes (with source and date)
- Official delegations, awards, board positions, distinctive public elements of their trajectory
- Reliable public information only; no private details or speculation
- If the current CEO can't be confirmed, says so and names the most senior confirmed decision-maker

US-183 SOURCES

Sources and evidence on every claim

As **a project user**, *I want to trace every fact to its source, so that I can rely on it in a meeting.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Each source shows publisher, direct link, date, headline, language and short summary
- Each important claim is labelled: Verified fact, Official announcement, Company claim, Media report, AI inference or Unconfirmed
- Official, company, stock-exchange, reputable media and ranking sources are preferred; aggregators and social posts are never the only source
- Several articles on the same development are consolidated, keeping the strongest sources
- Rankings show their publisher and date

US-184 PRIORITY

Why each company was included

As **a project user**, *I want to know why each company is on the list, so that I am never given an unexplained score.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Each result has a short reason covering commercial potential, leader relevance, strategic access, bilateral relevance, timeliness and evidence quality
- No score is shown without its explanation

US-185 BILATERAL

Publication-country connection

As **a project user**, *I want to see links to the publication's country flagged and prioritised, so that our approach has a stronger narrative.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Investment, trade, joint ventures, contracts, delegations, official visits and agreements are shown as a labelled badge with a source
- Results with a direct connection rank above comparable results without one
- Requests can target it directly, e.g. "Find major Nigerian companies expanding in or trading with the United States"

US-186 GOVERNMENT

Government links and institutional contacts

As **a project user**, *I want to see government links, with officials kept separate from advertisers, so that I can use them for access without confusing the pipeline.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- A company's government connection (contracts, concessions, state ownership, ministerial portfolio, delegations) is shown with sources
- Presidents, prime ministers, ministers and institutions appear as Institutional / access results, never as advertising prospects
- Each institutional result states its value: interview, introductions, companies in the portfolio or project support

US-187 FILTER

Filter and sort results

As **a project user**, *I want to filter and sort a list, so that I can find the companies worth acting on.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Filters: sector, revenue, qualification, public/private/state-owned, international presence, HubSpot status, investment activity, export activity, government connection, publication-country connection
- Sort by priority (default), revenue or name
- Filters combine and are kept in the link, so a filtered view can be shared

US-188 REFINE

Refine a list with a follow-up

As **a Project Director**, *I want to extend or narrow a list with a follow-up instruction, so that I don't start again from zero.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- e.g. "Add 20 more in energy", "Drop state-owned companies"
- Existing results, saves, ratings and Not relevant decisions are kept
- Only new or changed results are researched and charged
- Each refinement is recorded with who made it and when

US-189 PROFILE

Research one company in depth

As **a Project Director**, *I want to open the full profile of any company in a list, so that we only spend on depth where it is needed.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Shows the full company narrative and leader trajectory
- If not yet generated, Research in depth creates it after showing the cost
- A profile is saved and shared with the whole project; Refresh re-researches it and keeps the previous version

US-190 MANUAL

Add a company manually

As **a Project Director**, *I want to enter a company by name and country, so that a company the search missed gets the same research and can go to HubSpot.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Only company name and country are needed
- The system researches it, identifies its leader and prefills every verified field with sources
- It joins the project's research archive like any other result

US-191 SUPPRESS

Mark Not relevant

As **a Project Director**, *I want to mark a company or leader Not relevant, so that it doesn't keep coming back.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Hidden from all future lists and refinements in that project
- Optional reason recorded with who decided and when
- Only the Director or an Admin can reverse it, from a Not relevant list
- Applies to this project only

US-192 FEEDBACK

Save and rate results

As **a project user**, *I want to save a result and rate it Useful or Not useful, so that the team sees what is worth pursuing and TRC can measure quality.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Recorded per user and per project
- A Saved view lists everything I saved in the project
- Ratings never hide a result

US-193 ARCHIVE

Research archive and search

As **a project user**, *I want to keep and search every past research list, so that we build a reusable database instead of repeating research.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Lists every request with mode, request text, who ran it, date, result count and cost
- Search by company, person, sector, qualification and HubSpot status
- A company found in several lists is one record linked to each list

HUBSPOT INTEGRATION

US-194 SETUP

Connect HubSpot and map owners

As **an Admin**, *I want to connect TRC's HubSpot account and link each user to their HubSpot owner, so that checks and assignments use the real CRM.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Connect and test HubSpot from settings; last successful sync shown
- Credentials are stored on the server only, never in the browser
- Each user is mapped to a HubSpot owner; unmapped users can't be assigned
- Admin sets which HubSpot properties hold the project tag and the government-contact type

US-195 CHECK

Cross-check every result

As **a project user**, *I want to see every company and leader checked against HubSpot, so that I know immediately whether we already know them.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Statuses: company and CEO exist; company exists but CEO missing; contact exists without the correct company; possible duplicate; not in HubSpot
- Status shown on each result and available as a filter
- Re-checked when a list is older than 24 hours and always at approval
- The check only reads HubSpot; nothing is written without approval

US-196 MATCHING

Smart company and contact matching

As **a project user**, *I want to have matching catch the same company under a different name, so that we don't create duplicates.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Considers legal and trading names, abbreviations, website domain, subsidiaries, corporate group, spellings, transliteration and former names
- A domain or exact legal-name match counts as existing; weaker matches become Possible duplicate and are never merged automatically
- People are matched on name plus company, allowing for name variants

US-197 EXISTING

Existing prospects stay visible

As **a project user**, *I want to keep seeing companies already in HubSpot, with their CRM context, so that new intelligence can strengthen an approach we are already making.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Existing companies are never filtered out by default
- Shows HubSpot link, status, owner, last activity and whether the right CEO contact exists
- Shows the new intelligence and how it strengthens the reason for a meeting
- Existing record owners are never changed

US-198 DUPLICATES

Resolve a possible duplicate

As **a Project Director**, *I want to confirm or reject a possible duplicate, so that HubSpot stays clean.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Side-by-side view of the researched company and each HubSpot candidate
- Options: Same company (link), Different company (treat as new), Decide later
- Decision remembered for the project and recorded with who made it

US-199 ADD

Review and add a company and its leader

As **a Project Director**, *I want to add a company and its CEO to HubSpot after reviewing them, so that the team can start outreach.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Available from a results list, a company profile, a manual entry or a single-company search
- Review shows proposed company and contact data, sources, possible duplicates, project and assignee
- Approve creates the company, the contact and their association, and links to the new records
- The result's HubSpot status updates immediately

US-200 BULK

Bulk add selected companies

As **a Project Director**, *I want to add several selected companies in one review, so that I can move a good list into HubSpot quickly.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Companies are ticked individually; there is no "add entire list"
- One review screen shows every selected company with its data, duplicate status and assignee
- Approve is disabled while any row has an unresolved duplicate or no assignee
- Each row reports success or a clear error; failed rows can be retried without duplicating successful ones

US-201 ASSIGN

Mandatory assignment

As **a Project Director**, *I want to assign every new record to a team member, so that nothing sits in HubSpot without an owner.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- An assignee is required on every company and contact created
- Only project members mapped to a HubSpot owner can be chosen
- Bulk review offers Assign all to…, then each row can be changed
- The assignee becomes the HubSpot owner

US-202 CONTACT

Add a missing CEO to an existing company

As **a Project Director**, *I want to add the CEO when HubSpot has the company but not the person, so that the record is complete.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Creates only the contact and associates it with the existing company
- The existing company's owner and data are not changed
- Assignee defaults to the company's owner when that person is on the project

US-203 ASSOCIATION

Fix a contact's company link

As **a Project Director**, *I want to link an existing contact to the correct company, so that HubSpot reflects who leads what.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Proposes the association with the source showing the person's current role
- Written only after the Director confirms; existing associations are not removed

US-204 GOVERNMENT

Add a government contact

As **a Project Director**, *I want to add a president, prime minister, minister or official to HubSpot, so that interview and access work is tracked without mixing it into the advertising pipeline.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Classified as an Institutional / access contact, separate from commercial prospects
- Review shows the reason for adding: interview, introductions or project support
- Assignment is still mandatory

US-205 TAG

Tag records with the project

As **a Project Director**, *I want to have every record I create or link tagged with the project, so that the team can filter HubSpot by country report.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Companies and contacts carry the project (country and publication) in the configured HubSpot property
- Tagging an existing record adds this project and never removes another

US-206 DATA

Only verified data, editable before approval

As **a Project Director**, *I want to see proposed records contain only sourced data I can correct, so that HubSpot isn't filled with guesses.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Fields are prefilled only from sourced, non-inferred research; unverified fields stay blank
- Every prefilled field shows its source
- The Director can edit any field before approving; edits are recorded

US-207 LOG

CRM action log

As **a Project Director or Admin**, *I want to see every HubSpot action recorded, so that we can audit what was created and by whom.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Logs who, when, project, action, HubSpot record IDs, assignee, fields edited and result
- Append-only and kept even if the user is later removed

US-208 ACTIVITY

HubSpot activity read back

As **a Project Director or Admin**, *I want to see what happened to companies after they entered HubSpot, so that we can tell whether research leads to meetings.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Shows, where available: added, assigned, contacted, meeting scheduled, dismissed
- Read from HubSpot only; the module never writes activities
- Shown as a timeline on the company, linking research to later activity without claiming it caused it

TRACKING & GUARDRAILS

US-209 OVERVIEW

Project activity and quality overview

As **a Project Director or Admin**, *I want to see one summary of a project's research and CRM activity, so that I can manage the team's pipeline work and see what is useful.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Research runs, companies by qualification, companies added to HubSpot, assignments per member
- Useful / Not useful ratings and Not relevant decisions
- Admins can compare projects and research modes by date range

US-210 ANALYTICS

Usage and cost in analytics

As **an Admin**, *I want to see Country Intelligence cost alongside every other workflow, so that spend is visible per project and user.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Every AI call is logged in the existing usage ledger with tokens, web searches, cost, model and project
- Cost breaks down by project, user and research run

US-211 PROMPTS

Versioned research prompts

As **an Admin**, *I want to edit the research prompts with full version history, so that quality can be tuned without a code release and every result is traceable.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Each research mode's prompt and the qualification rules are editable, with history and rollback
- Every run stores the model and prompt version used

US-212 FAILURE

Research run fails partway

As **a Project Director**, *I want to keep what a failed run finished and retry the rest, so that I don't lose or pay twice for completed work.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Clear error message; completed companies are kept and marked Run incomplete
- Retry continues from where it stopped
- Spend up to the failure is still recorded

US-213 HUBSPOT

HubSpot unavailable

As **a project user**, *I want to keep researching when HubSpot is down, so that a CRM outage doesn't block preparation.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Research continues; HubSpot status shows Check unavailable — retry
- Add to HubSpot is disabled with a clear message until the connection works
- Rate limits are retried automatically; Admins see a banner if the connection is revoked

US-214 SECURITY

Roles and project status enforced

As **TRC**, *I want to enforce every permission and project status on the server, so that nobody reaches data or actions beyond their role.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Team members can't run Director actions, even through a direct request
- Users can't reach projects they aren't assigned to
- Paused and Closed projects block new research and HubSpot additions in the API, not only the screen

US-215 RACE

Re-check at approval

As **a Project Director**, *I want to have HubSpot re-checked the moment I approve, so that two people can't create the same company.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Every row is re-checked on approval; a row that now matches an existing record is held for review
- Retrying an approval never creates a second copy

US-216 SMALL MARKET

Fewer qualified companies than requested

As **a Project Director**, *I want to get honest results when the market is small, so that the list is never padded with weak companies.*

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- If 80 are requested but 35 qualify, 35 are returned with a short explanation
- Scale uncertain companies may be shown separately, clearly labelled, and never counted toward the target